

—	—	—	—	5	—	0	
—	—	—	—	—	—	7*	[+3]
miss	—	—	—	—	—	2	[the exemplars probably had none]
miss	—	—	—	miss	—	1	[the exemplar probably had none] ¹

Setting aside the 14 incomplete MSS, another 12 have a private pattern (so far). Two patterns show 2 MSS, another two show 3 MSS, while one shows 4 MSS. I will disregard all of these. I invite attention to the following seven patterns:

1. 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 = 23 [+2] MSS
2. —, —, —, 4, — = 14 MSS
3. —, —, —, —, — = 7 [+3] MSS
4. 1, 2, 3, —, 5 = 9 MSS
5. 1, —, —, —, 5 = 8 MSS
6. 1, —, —, 4, — = 7 MSS
7. —, —, 3, —, — = 6 MSS

I consider that pattern 1) represents the family archetype; it is by far the strongest pattern and of necessity represents a line of transmission. But what of pattern 2); did 14 copyists just happen to make the same set of choices independently? Is it not far more likely that they represent an independent line of transmission? Indeed, I have collated many dozens of **f**³⁵ MSS, and with few exceptions the copyists were faithful to their exemplar. For example, consider the following evidence for six of the patterns listed above:

- Pattern 1)— GA 2554 (Bucharest, 1434, eap) is a precisely perfect copy of the line of transmission that has Pattern 1). There are several others that are all but perfect.
- Pattern 2)— GA 867 (Vatican, XIV, e) is missing the first five chapters of Matthew, but otherwise is a precisely perfect copy of the line of transmission that has Pattern 2). GA 128 (Vatican, XIII, e) is almost perfect.
- Pattern 3)— GA 1189 (Sinai, 1346, e) is a virtually perfect copy of the line of transmission that has Pattern 3). GA 928 (Dionysiu, 1304, eap), GA 1572 (Vatopediu, 1304, e) and GA 2466 (Patmos, 1329, eap) are all good.

¹ Do not all the solitary patterns, indeed the wide variety of patterns (at least 24), indicate that the transmission was normal? There was no enforced conformity.